— issue 025 —

The Morning Oracle

PRICE · ONE COFFEE · MORNING EDITION 025

✦ WHAT TOMORROW HOLDS, READ THIS MORNING ✦

MORNING EDITION
Saturday, October 24, 2026
FOUR COLUMNS · TWO PAGES

FIGURE OF THE DAY
$31,500
a month: Links (reported).

WORD OF THE DAY
Dark energy
n. — definition on page 2.

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☞ FRONT PAGE · AI

FIGMA'S AGENT LEARNS YOUR DESIGN SYSTEM'S RULES

Figma publishes a guide so its agent follows your components and your rules.

EXCLUSIVE

On October 23, Figma published a guide on giving its agent the context of a design system: it works better when it knows your components and your written rules.

First step, connect the published library via "Libraries": the agent then uses approved components instead of inventing styles. Next come guidelines (which button for a payment, which for "Back"), examples, and skills launched with "/".

Figma notes that guidelines mainly help when creating, not editing. Review the output: the agent can make mistakes.

TECH IN BRIEF

VERCEL: SET A BUDGET FROM THE CLI

Since October 23, *vercel budgets set --amount* sets a team's budget; **--pause** stops production at 100% of spend.

Without it, nothing stops. *vercel budgets alerts* shows the alert history. Owner and Billing roles only.

THE LAB ANSWERS

The riddle

You can't see me, but I'm suspected of stretching the Universe ever faster. What am I?

Answer: dark energy

THE QUOTE

"The details are not details," said Charles. "They make the product."

— Charles Eames, as reported by Herman Miller

CASE STUDY

LINKS: $31,500 A MONTH, WITH $5 SUBSCRIPTIONS

A "link in bio" page builder made in two weeks in 2019, a salary a few years later.

Charlie Clark, a software engineer, launched Links (liinks.co) in 2019 in about two weeks, while another project, a print-on-demand marketplace, was struggling. He had noticed artists using Linktree and built a more polished, mobile-first alternative.

Validation was done by hand: he built pages for artists he knew, then a Product Hunt launch brought traffic and the paid plan reached about $100 in monthly revenue within a few months. According to the interview Starter Story published on October 21, the Premium plan costs $5 a month ($4 before a June increase that added nearly $5,000 in monthly revenue) and Pro starts at $12, with customers paying over $100. Monthly recurring revenue is about $31,500.

On acquisition: Instagram ads worked at first then declined, and Google ads, around $100 a day, have been the main channel for about four years. The founder left his salaried job in August 2024, when Links caught up with his salary.

Takeaways: many small subscriptions, a pricier tier for heavy users, and patience. Downsides: reliance on one ad channel, and figures reported by the founder, not verified.

TODAY'S PET PEEVE

MOVING TO MACOS 27 CAN SWITCH OFF YOUR CODE SCANNING

A system update can strip a code-analysis tool of part of its abilities.

On October 19, GitHub warned that CodeQL, its code-analysis tool, can no longer trace builds on Xcode 27 for C/C++, C#, Go, Java, Kotlin and Swift, and may not on macOS 27. Cause: Apple is removing Intel code from some system binaries the tool relies on. Swift 6.4 is not supported on any platform.

The suggested fix: stay on macOS 26 and Xcode 26, and pin the image and toolchain in GitHub Actions rather than following "latest". For C/C++, C# and Java, a mode that doesn't trace the build exists. And support for Intel Macs will be deprecated in mid-December 2026.

BUSINESS LEAD

A compatibility watch for small teams: you list your toolchain (system, compiler, security scanners), and a message warns you before an update breaks one of them. Competition: vendors' release notes, which you have to read yourself; I haven't checked whether a dedicated tool already exists.

SCIENCE IN 5 LINES

2,884 SUPERNOVAE REOPEN THE DARK ENERGY DEBATE

What if the force accelerating the Universe's expansion isn't constant?

An international team led from the University of Queensland re-analyzed 2,884 Type Ia supernovae, the stellar explosions used as distance markers.

It recalibrated measurements across telescopes and corrected for dust, host-galaxy mass and gravitational lensing, then combined them with cosmic microwave background data and galaxy maps.

A cautious verdict: the results "may" point to dark energy that changes over time, against the standard model where it is constant.

Safeguards: the work is posted on arXiv, the deviation does not point quite the same way as the Dark Energy Survey's in 2024, and the release claims no confirmed detection.

TECH

VERCEL: DEPLOY WITHOUT AN ACCOUNT, FOR ONE HOUR

Since October 22, the *vercel deploy --temporary* command publishes a project, or a single file like *prototype.html*, without a Vercel account. It gives a shareable address on the tmp.now domain.

The deployment expires after one hour unless claimed through the link in the command's output, which requires signing in or creating an account. That link must stay private. Condition: a folder not linked to Vercel.

BUSINESS ANGLE

Show a prototype to a client without them creating anything: a platform's first trial is played before sign-up.

THE WORD

Dark energy, *n.* : Name given to the unknown cause of the accelerating expansion of the Universe. In the standard model it is constant; recent supernova measurements leave open the idea that it changes over time.

READER'S NOTEBOOK — SOMETHING THAT BUGGED YOU TODAY, AN IDEA:

The Morning Oracle — morning paper written and typeset by Claude for 1977 Éditions, from an idea by Michael Misran.
Sources: figma.com · starterstory.com · github.blog · sciencedaily.com · vercel.com · hermanmiller.com